

Snack Smart: 20 Quick & Nutritious Bites

(Approximate nutrition per serving) No oven needed — made with tawa, kadai, steamer, or no cooking at all

1. Roasted Makhana

Calories: 140 | **Protein:** 5g | **Fat:** 7g | **Carbs:** 15g

Ingredients: - 1.5 cups makhana (fox nuts) - 1 tsp ghee - Chaat masala, black salt

Procedure: Roast makhana in ghee in a kadai on low flame for 5-7 minutes until crisp. Toss with chaat masala and black salt while warm.

2. Roasted Chana Dal Namkeen (Bhuna Dalia)

Calories: 130 | **Protein:** 7g | **Fat:** 3g | **Carbs:** 18g

Ingredients: - 1 cup roasted split chana dal (dalia) - Curry leaves, mustard seeds, a few drops of oil - Salt, pinch of turmeric

Procedure: Heat a few drops of oil in a kadai, splutter mustard seeds and curry leaves, add turmeric. Toss in roasted dalia and mix on low flame for 2 minutes. Cool and store — a light, crunchy, protein-rich snack with no added sugar.

3. Shallow-Fried Sweet Potato Fingers

Calories: 160 | **Protein:** 4g | **Fat:** 6g | **Carbs:** 26g

Ingredients: - 1 medium sweet potato, cut into fingers - 1 tsp oil - Chaat masala, salt

Procedure: Shallow-fry sweet potato fingers in a pan with 1 tsp oil on medium flame, turning until golden and soft inside (about 10 minutes). Sprinkle chaat masala and serve hot. (*Air fryer: 180°C for 15 min if available.*)

4. Veggie Sticks with Hummus

Calories: 170 | **Protein:** 7g | **Fat:** 8g | **Carbs:** 18g

Ingredients: - Carrot, cucumber, capsicum sticks - 1/2 cup boiled chickpeas - 1 tbsp peanut butter or tahini, lemon, garlic

Procedure: Blend chickpeas with peanut butter, lemon juice, garlic and a little water into a smooth dip. Serve with fresh vegetable sticks. No cooking needed beyond boiling the chickpeas.

5. Tawa-Roasted Beetroot Chips

Calories: 110 | **Protein:** 2g | **Fat:** 4g | **Carbs:** 17g

Ingredients: - 1 medium beetroot, thinly sliced - 1 tsp oil - Salt, pepper

Procedure: Heat a tawa with a few drops of oil. Place beetroot slices in a single layer, cover with a lid, and roast on low flame, flipping every 2-3 minutes until crisp. Sprinkle salt and pepper.

6. Matki Sprouts Chaat

Calories: 150 | **Protein:** 9g | **Fat:** 4g | **Carbs:** 20g

Ingredients: - 1 cup sprouted matki (moth beans) - Chopped onion, tomato, coriander - Lemon juice, chaat masala

Procedure: Steam sprouted matki for 5 minutes. Toss with chopped onion, tomato, coriander, lemon juice and chaat masala. Serve fresh.

7. Simple Corn Chaat

Calories: 140 | **Protein:** 4g | **Fat:** 3g | **Carbs:** 26g

Ingredients: - 1 cup boiled sweet corn - Chopped onion, tomato, coriander - Lemon juice, chaat masala

Procedure: Boil or steam corn until tender. Toss with chopped onion, tomato, coriander, lemon juice and chaat masala. Ready in minutes — no special equipment needed.

8. Masala Puffed Rice (Murmura) Mix

Calories: 150 | **Protein:** 4g | **Fat:** 6g | **Carbs:** 20g

Ingredients: - 2 cups puffed rice (murmura) - 2 tbsp roasted peanuts - Curry leaves, mustard seeds, turmeric, 1 tsp oil

Procedure: Heat oil in a kadai, splutter mustard seeds and curry leaves, add turmeric and roasted peanuts. Toss in puffed rice and mix until evenly coated. Cool and store in an airtight jar.

9. Steamed Edamame with Sea Salt

Calories: 120 | **Protein:** 11g | **Fat:** 5g | **Carbs:** 9g

Ingredients: - 1 cup edamame (in pods) - Sea salt or black salt - Squeeze of lemon (optional)

Procedure: Steam or boil edamame pods for 5 minutes. Drain, sprinkle with sea salt and a squeeze of lemon. Serve warm — one of the simplest, highest-protein snacks on this list.

10. Mixed Nut & Seed Mix

Calories: 200 | **Protein:** 7g | **Fat:** 16g | **Carbs:** 8g

Ingredients: - 5 almonds, 4 walnut halves - 1 tbsp pumpkin seeds, 1 tbsp sunflower seeds

Procedure: Mix all the nuts and seeds together in a small bowl or pouch. No cooking needed — ready to grab and go.

11. Seasonal Fruit Chaat

Calories: 110 | **Protein:** 2g | **Fat:** 1g | **Carbs:** 26g

Ingredients: - 1 cup mixed seasonal fruits (apple, guava, pomegranate) - Chaat masala, black salt, lemon juice

Procedure: Chop fruits into bite-sized pieces, sprinkle with chaat masala, black salt and lemon juice, and toss gently. Serve immediately.

12. Cucumber-Curd Boats

Calories: 90 | **Protein:** 4g | **Fat:** 3g | **Carbs:** 10g

Ingredients: - 2 small cucumbers, halved and scooped - 1/2 cup hung curd - Roasted cumin powder, mint

Procedure: Mix hung curd with roasted cumin powder and chopped mint. Fill scooped cucumber halves with the mixture. Serve chilled — no cooking required.

13. Dry Fruit & Nut Trail Mix

Calories: 190 | **Protein:** 5g | **Fat:** 11g | **Carbs:** 20g

Ingredients: - 1 tbsp raisins, 1 tbsp dried cranberries - 5 cashews, 5 almonds - 1 tsp pumpkin seeds

Procedure: Mix all ingredients in a small jar. Store airtight for a ready-to-eat sweet and crunchy snack.

14. Sattu Protein Cooler

Calories: 90 | **Protein:** 7g | **Fat:** 1g | **Carbs:** 12g

Ingredients: - 2 tbsp roasted sattu (gram flour) - 1 cup water - Roasted cumin powder, black salt, lemon juice

Procedure: Whisk sattu with water until smooth. Add roasted cumin powder, black salt and lemon juice. Serve chilled — a light, protein-rich cooler with no added sugar or ghee.

15. Spiced Roasted Peanuts & Seeds

Calories: 180 | **Protein:** 7g | **Fat:** 12g | **Carbs:** 10g

Ingredients: - 1/2 cup peanuts - 2 tbsp pumpkin seeds, 2 tbsp sunflower seeds - Roasted cumin powder, chili powder, salt

Procedure: Dry roast peanuts and seeds separately in a kadai on low flame until fragrant. Toss together with cumin powder, chili powder and salt while warm.

16. Roasted Soya Nuts Namkeen

Calories: 170 | **Protein:** 12g | **Fat:** 8g | **Carbs:** 12g

Ingredients: - 1 cup soaked soya nuts (dried soybeans) - 1 tsp oil - Chaat masala, black salt

Procedure: Soak soybeans overnight, pat dry, and roast in a kadai with a little oil until golden and crunchy. Toss with chaat masala and black salt while warm. Store airtight for a protein-packed munch.

17. Roasted Banana Chips

Calories: 130 | **Protein:** 1g | **Fat:** 4g | **Carbs:** 24g

Ingredients: - 2 raw bananas, thinly sliced - 1 tsp oil - Salt, turmeric

Procedure: Shallow-fry thin banana slices in a pan with a little oil on medium-low flame, turning until golden and crisp, about 8-10 minutes. Sprinkle salt and turmeric. (*Air fryer: 180°C for 15 min if available.*)

18. Peanut Butter & Banana Bites

Calories: 150 | **Protein:** 5g | **Fat:** 8g | **Carbs:** 18g

Ingredients: - 1 banana, sliced into rounds - 1 tbsp peanut butter - 1 tsp chia seeds

Procedure: Spread a small dollop of peanut butter on each banana round and sprinkle with chia seeds. Ready in under 2 minutes — no cooking required.

19. Mint-Cucumber Cooler Popsicles

Calories: 40 | **Protein:** 1g | **Fat:** 0g | **Carbs:** 9g

Ingredients: - 1 cucumber, chopped - Mint leaves, lemon juice - 1 tsp honey

Procedure: Blend cucumber, mint, lemon juice and honey with a little water until smooth. Pour into popsicle molds and freeze for 4-6 hours.

20. Masala Oats Crunch

Calories: 140 | **Protein:** 5g | **Fat:** 4g | **Carbs:** 20g

Ingredients: - 1 cup rolled oats - 1 tbsp peanuts, curry leaves, mustard seeds - A few drops of oil, salt, turmeric

Procedure: Dry roast oats in a kadai for 3-4 minutes until light and crisp; set aside. In the same kadai, heat a few drops of oil, splutter mustard seeds and curry leaves, add peanuts and turmeric, then toss the roasted oats back in with salt. Ready in under 10 minutes — savory, light, no added sugar.

Note: Nutrition values are approximate estimates and may vary based on exact quantities and brands used. Recommend a nutrition-calculation review before final print if precision is important for clinical credibility.